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Figure12.9. Artificially coloured MRI scan of human brain

Clinical significance

MR imaging of the body is performed to evaluate organs of the chest and abdomen, pelvic organs including the bladder and the reproductive organs, blood vessels and lymph nodes.

Physicians use an MR examination to help diagnose or monitor treatment for conditions such as:

- Tumours of the chest, abdomen or pelvis.
- Diseases of the liver, inflammatory bowel disease, heart problems, such as congenital heart disease.
- Malformation of the blood vessels and inflammation of the vessels (vasculitis).
- A foetus in the womb of a pregnant woman.
- Visualising injuries, torn ligaments especially in areas like wrist ankle or knee

Why the magnetic resonance imaging technique gives excellent job of showing soft tissues and blood vessels?

12.3. Therapeutic Instruments

Pacemakers

Pacemaker is a medical device which uses electrical impulses, delivered by electrodes contracting the heart muscles, to regulate the beating of the heart

The primary purpose of a pacemaker is to maintain an adequate heart rate, either